MC 451 Weekly reading journal rubric

10 points. Due every Friday, 11:59 PM (remaining entries: October 16, 23 and 30, November 6, 13 and 20, December 4).

How this is scored. Add the points from each row; the total is out of 10. A first attempt is graded forgivingly: a part that is there but incomplete earns partial credit, and 0 is kept for a part that is missing. Writing more than the word range asks for never costs points. Submissions are unlimited before the deadline, so you can revise and submit again.

- Length: 250 to 300 words per entry. Write on the assigned chapter; you are not required to read outside the textbook.
- Choose one of three thinking paths. The Connector links the reading to your project, other concepts, or real-world examples. The Troubleshooter documents a challenge you met and how you worked through it. The Critic asks critical questions, challenges assumptions, or explores implications.
- Each entry is scored out of 10. The three thinking paths (Connector, Troubleshooter, Critic) are equal; none scores higher than another.
- If AI shaped any work you submitted that week, the entry must say what you used it for and how you checked its output. The AURA Lab R Companion is not AI: its setup check, its error explanations, and any code its menus write are not logged.

Weekly reading journal, 10 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Works with the chapter 4 points	**4 points.** Works with a specific concept, example or passage from this week's chapter, named so a reader could find it.	**3 points.** Works with this week's chapter, but describes the concept or passage in general terms instead of naming it.	**2 points.** Mentions the chapter's topic, but the entry is mostly about something else, or summarizes the chapter without a point of your own.	**0 to 1 points.** The chapter is hard to find in the entry, or the entry is about a different week's reading.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Depth, through the path you chose 3 points	**3 points.** Works one or two ideas all the way through. A Connector explains the link, a Troubleshooter shows the problem and how it was solved, a Critic asks the question and says why it matters. Being confused or skeptical is fine when you say about what.	**2 points.** Develops one idea, but stops before saying what follows from it.	**1 point.** Lists several ideas with a sentence each. An entry under 250 words usually lands here: the idea is named but not worked through, so add what the reading claims and what you make of it.	**0 points.** No idea is developed past naming it.
Connection 3 points	**3 points.** Ties the reading to your own project, an earlier reading, or a real example, and says what the tie shows.	**2 points.** Names a link to your project, an earlier reading or an example, without saying what it shows.	**1 point.** The link is one that could be written without having read the chapter.	**0 points.** No link to your project, an earlier reading, or a real example.

Journal consistency

10 points. End of term. Scored once, at the end of the term, from the dates your entries came in.

Journal consistency, 10 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Entries across the term 10 points	**10 points.** All 14 entries submitted, each by its due date.	**8 to 9 points.** 12 or 13 entries submitted by their due dates.	**5 to 7 points.** 9 to 11 entries submitted by their due dates.	**0 to 4 points.** 8 or fewer entries submitted by their due dates.